



National University of Ireland, Dublin

Bachelor of Business Studies

Intake 69

Module: Digital Business (MIS2002S)

Report Title: OTWC - Winning Shelves, Losing Loyalty

Group Member Names & Student ID:

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I declare that all materials included in this essay/report/project/dissertation is the end result of my own work and that due acknowledgement have been given in the bibliography and references to ALL sources be they printed, electronic or personal.

Signed: **Group 7**

Date : 15 July 2026



Winning Shelves, Losing Loyalty

How a heritage dual engine scaled across Asia on digital rails it does not own.



THE DUAL ENGINE VALUE CHAIN

one bean supply, two integrated routes to the same customer



KEY FACTS

1999



founded in Ipoh as a 3in1 maker; first kopitiam cafe 2005

232



outlets in 7 markets at the JDE offer: 189 MY + 9 SG

RM1.47B



JDE takeover, Dec 2017, at RM3.18 a share

17+



export markets; first export to Singapore in 2000

18-35

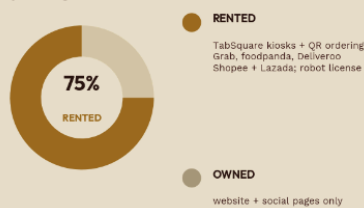


target market: kopitiam nostalgia in modern spots

ADOPTION VERDICT
digital, but rented

WHO OWNS THE DIGITAL RAILS?

of 8 customer facing touchpoints, only 2 belong to OTWC itself



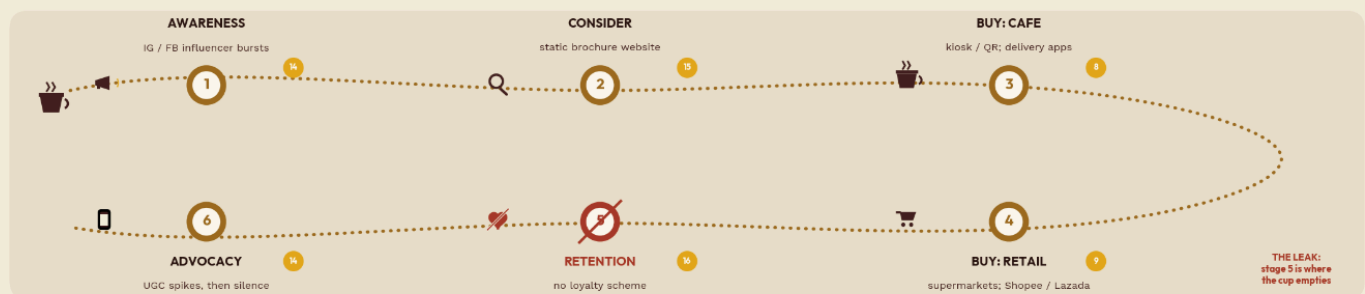
AI + TECH TIMELINE



SWOT SNAPSHOT



THE CONSUMER PURCHASING JOURNEY: DIGITAL TOUCHPOINTS



MARKET: EACH RIVAL ATTACKS ONE ENGINE

ADVANTAGE: the only heritage player running BOTH engines at scale,
bean to cup integration plus JDE's global distribution



SOCIAL MEDIA USE

campaign bursts + marketplace links; spikes of engagement, then silence. No always on community.



CRITICAL ANALYSIS

The dual engine plus JDE scale is a real moat, yet every digital touchpoint that matters is rented: vendors and platforms capture the data while OTWC pays the fees. The 18 to 35 target is met at purchase but lost at retention. The gap is not technology adoption. It is customer ownership.

KEY TAKEAWAY

OTWC digitised its transactions but never its relationships. A loyalty layer uniting cafe + FMCG data turns rented rails into an owned moat.

TRANSACTIONS: FULL
RELATIONSHIPS: EMPTY

SOURCES

COMPANY & DEAL

- [1] Wikipedia, OldTown White Coffee
- [2] SparrowPH, OldTown case (232 outlets)
- [3] The Edge SG (2017), JDE RM1.47b offer
- [4] JDE (2017), offer announcement RM1.18
- [5] FMT (2017), takeover report

EXPORTS & FRANCHISE

- [6] Ciklom, 17+ export markets
- [7] Mini Ho Insights (2024), robot barista
- [8] Mini Ho Insights (2022), Shopee store
- [11] Backscoop, franchise history

TECH & PLATFORMS

- [8] TabSquare, OTWC outlet listings
- [10] Inside Retail Asia (2018), Suntec + Yahoo Finance (2019), TabSquare AI
- [16] Loylogic, Dolce Gusto loyalty

FULL APA REFERENCE LIST + FACT TABLE IN PART A OF THE REPORT

MARKETING ANALYSIS

- [12] Trade press: Papparich, Oriental Kopi, Chek Hup, Ya Kun
- [13] Oum (2024), OTWC strategy
- [14] iSearch Marketing, influencers
- [15] oldtown.com.my, official site

Part A – Infographics Supporting Information

Topic of the Infographic

Old Town White Coffee

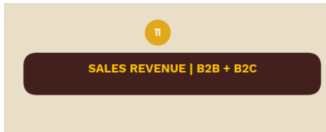
“Winning Shelves, Losing Loyalty”

In the table below, enter the facts contained in your infographic, how they are represented graphically and their source. (min 15 sources)

1	**All images used in infographics	** Indicate the facts you want to discuss in relation to the image used. Do not copy and paste from various sources	**Reference list. APA Referencing. 1 image / fact can have multiple sources.
2		Background Founded in 1999 Ipoh, Malaysia. Started as a 3 in 1 instant coffee mix manufacturer in 2005 they open the first retail outlet.traditional nostalgic malaysia theme	OLDTOWN. (n.d.) <i>how OLDTOWN popularized White Coffee from Ipoh, to the World</i>. Available at: https://www.oldtown.com.my/our-story/ [Accessed: July 2026]
3		Franchiser in 2007, the company developed its profit sharing franchising model, operating nearly 100 franchised outlets globally by 2011 Today, they got 189 outlets in Malaysia, and 9 in singapore	The BackScoop. (n.d.). <i>OldTown White Coffee: The founders wanted to recreate the classic Malaysian coffee shop experience</i>. Available at: https://www.backscoop.com/newsletter-posts/oldtown-white-coffee-the-brand-that-introduced-malaysian-white-coffee-to-the-world [Accessed: July 26]

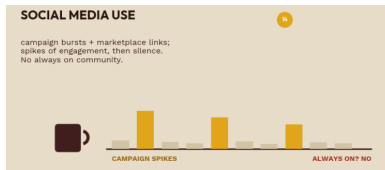
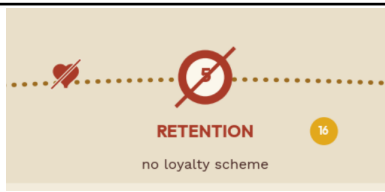


4	 RM1.47B JDE takeover, Dec 2017, at RM3.18 a share	Success Story in early 2018 they got acquired by Dutch tea & Coffee Giants, Jacobs Douwe Egberts (JDE) for S\$488 Million at RM 3.18 per share Today they manufactured and exported to 21 countries worldwide	Woo, J. (2017) <i>Dutch tea and coffee giant brews \$488m buyout offer for Malaysia-listed OldTown White Coffee</i>. The Straits Times. Available at: https://www.straitstimes.com/business/companies-markets/dutch-tea-and-coffee-giant-brews-488m-buyout-offer-for-malaysia-listed [Accessed: July 2026]
5	 PAPPARICH dual engine rival ORIENTAL KOPI heritage challenger CHEK HUP FMCG shelves YA KUN kaya toast retail	Main competitor (direct) PappaRich Group: Operates a competing dual engine business model that directly challenge OldTown across both retail casual dining and processed consumer goods Oriental Kopi: Rapidly growing competitor targeting OldTown's traditional Nanyang Cafe heritage through heavy retail branding and direct to consumer product lines Chek Hup/Ya Kun Kaya Toast: While individual regional players like Chek Hup (FMCG dominance) and Ya Kun Kaya Toast (Retail dominance) operate asymmetric models, they form a combined competitive cluster against OldTown's dual engine market share.	The Edge Malaysia. (2026). Cover story: <i>Oriental Kopi takes slow-brew approach to growth</i>. Available at: https://theedgemalaysia.com/node/797164 [Accessed: July 26] PappaRich. (n.d.). About PappaRich. Available at: https://www.papparich.com.sg/about-papparich/ [Accessed: July 26] Chek Hup. (n.d.). What we do. Available at: https://chekhup.com.my/what-we-do/ [Accessed: July 2026]

6		Manufacturer side business model OldTown operates a dual-engine business model that vertically integrates FMCG manufacturing with a regional brick-and-mortar retail network. FMCG Division: Processes, packages, and globally distributes instant coffee mixes, ready-to-drink beverages, and roasted beans across supermarkets, convenience stores, and e-commerce platforms.	Marketing-Interactive. (2026). Can OldTown White Coffee bridge generations through its cold push? [online] Available at: https://www.marketing-interactive.com/can-oldtown-white-coffee-bridge-generations-through-its-cold-push
7		Food & Retail side business model Food & Retail Division: Operates and franchises a highly standardized network of full-service, casual dining cafés across major regional hubs, including Malaysia, Singapore, and Hong Kong.	Kingdom Digital. (2026). <i>OldTown White Coffee bridges tradition and innovation with new campaign.</i> https://kingdomdigital.com.sg/news/kingdom-digital-and-old-town-white-coffee-latest-integrated-campaign
8		Revenue model Business 2 Consumers current food product line Signature White Coffee, Kaya & Butter Toast, Ipoh Chicken Hor Fun, Nasi lemak, Old Town Curry Mee revenue model Business 2 Business 3-in 1 instant coffee mix	Sam
9		Current forms of AI and Tech 2018: TabSquare AI kiosk with facial recognition (Suntec outlet) 2020: QR ordering + TabSquare online ordering platform 2024: OTWC-branded robotic barista (licensing venture)	Inside Retail Asia (2018) <i>Oldtown White Coffee Concept Store Opens at Suntec.</i> Available at: https://insideretail.asia/2018/10/03/oldtown-white-coffee-concept-store-opens-at-suntec-2/ [Accessed: July 2026]. TabSquare (n.d.) OldTown White Coffee Singapore — Restaurant List. Available at:

		Ongoing: TabSquare AI analytics for sales/labour optimisation Ongoing: Shopee/Lazada stores + third-party delivery	https://outlets.tabsquare.com/OldTownWhiteCoffeeSingapore/ [Accessed: July 2026]. Mini Me Insights (2024) OLDTOWN White Coffee Robotic Chef and Barista Open for Franchise. Available at: https://www.minimeinsights.com/2024/06/09/oldtown-white-coffee-robotic-chef-and-barista-open-for-franchise/ [Accessed: July 2026]. OldTown Express (n.d.) Old Town White Coffee Robotic Machine — Fully Automated F&B AI Machine Running 24/7. Available at: https://oldtownexpress.com/ [Accessed: July 2026]. (Note: licensing-partner site, not OTWC's official corporate domain — cite alongside Mini Me Insights, not alone) Lazada Malaysia (2025) OLDTOWN White Coffee Malaysia Official Online Store. Available at: https://www.lazada.com.my/shop/oldtown-white-coffee/ [Accessed: July 2026]. Minime Insights (2022) OLDTOWN White Coffee Celebrates Heritage With New Offerings [confirms official Shopee flagship store]. Available at: https://www.minimeinsights.com/2022/12/18/oldtown-white-coffee-celebrates-heritage-with-new-offerings/ [Accessed: July 2026]. TabSquare (2022) OldTown White Coffee Chooses Automation Try TabSquare For Your Restaurant's Success [Video]. Available at: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zNAbk8I1pol [Accessed: July 2026].
10	18-35 target market: kopitiam nostalgia in modern spots	Target market 18 - 35 year olds who like a nostalgic kopitiam environment in modern accessible locations	Osum (2024) <i>The Art of Branding: Old Town White Coffees Strategic Marketing Approach</i>. Available at: https://blog.osum.com/old-town-white-coffee-marketing-strategy/ [Accessed: July 2026].



11		consumer journey map <table><thead><tr><th>Stage</th><th>Current touchpoint</th><th>Digital?</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>Awareness</td><td>Social media (IG/FB), influencer campaigns, pop-up events</td><td>Yes (social), partial (earned media)</td></tr><tr><td>Consideration</td><td>Store visibility (malls/transit hubs), website/menu pages</td><td>Weak — website is static, brochure-style</td></tr><tr><td>Purchase (café)</td><td>In-store, or via GrabFood/Foodpanda/Deliveroo</td><td>Yes, but outsourced to 3rd parties</td></tr><tr><td>Purchase (retail sachets)</td><td>Supermarkets, e-commerce (e.g. OG Singapore)</td><td>Minimal owned e-commerce</td></tr><tr><td>Post-purchase / retention</td><td>No consistent loyalty mechanism</td><td>Gap</td></tr><tr><td>Advocacy</td><td>UGC/hashtag campaigns at pop-ups</td><td>Yes, but campaign-based, not always-on</td></tr></tbody></table>	Stage	Current touchpoint	Digital?	Awareness	Social media (IG/FB), influencer campaigns, pop-up events	Yes (social), partial (earned media)	Consideration	Store visibility (malls/transit hubs), website/menu pages	Weak — website is static, brochure-style	Purchase (café)	In-store, or via GrabFood/Foodpanda/Deliveroo	Yes, but outsourced to 3rd parties	Purchase (retail sachets)	Supermarkets, e-commerce (e.g. OG Singapore)	Minimal owned e-commerce	Post-purchase / retention	No consistent loyalty mechanism	Gap	Advocacy	UGC/hashtag campaigns at pop-ups	Yes, but campaign-based, not always-on	sgfoodprice.org (2025) <i>OLDTOWN WHITE COFFEE SINGAPORE MENU PRICES 2026</i>. Explore Singapore Restaurant Menus With Prices. Available at: https://sgfoodprice.org/oldtown-white-coffee-singapore-menu [Accessed: July 2026]. Foodpanda.Sg (2026). <i>Old Town White Coffee [Catering] - Restaurant Delivery</i>. Available at: https://www.foodpanda.sg/restaurant/a2hw/old-town-white-coffee-catering-restaurant-delivery [Accessed: July 2026].
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12		online presence Marketing is campaign-focused and short spikes of engagement	ISearchMarketing.com.au (2026). Social Influencer Campaign For OLDTOWN White Coffee. I Search Marketing. Available at: https://isearchmarketing.com.au/social-influencer-campaign-for-oldtown-white-coffee/ [Accessed: July 2026].																					
13		Loyalty rewards OTWC does not have a loyalty points program unlike competitors like Coffee Bean & Tea Leaf Customer Loyalty Gap	Loylogic. (2026). <i>Scaling a world-class loyalty program: Nescafé Dolce Gusto</i>. Available at: https://www.loylogic.com/blogs/scaling-a-world-class-loyalty-program-nescafe-dolce-gusto																					

		OTWC does not have a easy loyalty program such as Nescafe's Dolce Gusto program which allows frictionless subscriptions of the Nescafe pods	[Accessed: July 2026].
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Part B – Recommendations

Insert Video Link Below:

https://youtu.be/S8zvITxz_Yo

**** Please ensure your presentation does not exceed a total of 15 minutes.**



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